Retail and wholesale of consumer goods

28% | Global 22%	38% | Global 39%	78% | Global 83%	87% | Global 88%
Labour-market churn	**Skill disruption**	**Organizations with DEI priorities**	**AI exposure**
Five-year structural labour-force churn	Shares of core skills which will change	Share of organizations with DEI priorities	Share of organizations running AI programmes

Trend outlook

Macrotrends driving business transformation

Share of organizations surveyed that identified this trend as likely to drive transformation in their organization

Industry Global

	Industry	Global
Rising cost of living, higher prices or inflation	69%	50%
Increased focus on labour and social issues	64%	46%
Broadening digital access	60%	60%
Slower economic growth	47%	42%
Ageing and declining working-age populations	43%	40%
Increased efforts and investments to reduce carbon…	41%	47%
Increased efforts and investments to adapt to climate…	30%	41%
Increased restrictions to global trade and investment	27%	23%
Increased geopolitical division and conflicts	25%	34%
Growing working-age populations	24%	24%
Increased government subsidies and industrial policy	18%	21%
Stricter anti-trust and competition regulations	17%	17%

Technology trends

Technology trends driving business transformation

Share of organizations surveyed that identify the technology trend as likely to drive business transformation

Industry Global

	Industry	Global
AI and information processing technologies (big data, VR, AR…	87%	86%
Robots and autonomous systems	71%	58%
Energy generation, storage and distribution	38%	41%
New materials and composites	33%	30%
Sensing, laser and optical technologies	18%	18%
Semiconductors and computing technologies	13%	20%
Quantum and encryption	7%	12%
Biotechnology and gene technologies	6%	11%
Satellites and space technologies	3%	9%

Jobs outlook

Key roles for business transformation

Roles most selected by organizations surveyed, ordered by net role growth, and their net growth and structural churn (percent)

Net growth Job Growth Job displacement Net Growth Global net growth

1. Net growth 2. Global net growth 3. Churn

NET GROWTH -100% 0 100%

	1.	2.	3.
AI and Machine Learning Specialists	44	82	44
General and Operations Managers	27	4	29
Business Development Professionals	22	19	22
Shop Salespersons	14	6	24
Accounting, Bookkeeping and Payroll Clerks	-14	-18	20
Data Entry Clerks	-24	-26	26

Skill outlook

Skills of increasing use by 2030

Skills of the most increase in use by 2030

Industry Global

CORE SKILLS OF 2025		SKILLS OF INCREASING USE BY 2030	
Leadership and social influence	73%	AI and big data	86%
Resilience, flexibility and agility	73%	Resilience, flexibility and agility	69%
Analytical thinking	71%	Technological literacy	69%
Empathy and active listening	68%	Networks and cybersecurity	68%
Motivation and self-awareness	64%	Curiosity and lifelong learning	67%

Workforce Strategy outlook

Key components of your workforce strategy by 2030

% surveyed organizations selecting the macrotrend to drive workforce transformation

Industry Global

	INDUSTRY	GLOBAL
Upskill your workforce	88%	85%
Accelerate the automation of processes and tasks	76%	73%
Hire staff with new skills to meet emerging business needs	70%	70%

Upskilling and reskilling outlook

42 | Global 41	29 | Global 29	18 | Global 19	10 | Global 11
Would not need training by 2030	Would be upskilled in their current role	Would be upskilled and redeployed	Would be unlikely to upskill

Retail and wholesale of consumer goods

Human-machine frontier

Human-machine frontier

% of tasks completed by predominantly people, predominantly technology, or a combination of both

Human | Global | Combination | Global | Technology | Global

ALL TASKS

Now

56% 27% 17%

48% 30% 22%

2030

42% 32% 26%

33% 33% 34%

Business Practice

Business practices to improve talent availability

Top practices with the greatest potential to improve talent availability (share of organizations surveyed)

Industry ▲ Global

	INDUSTRY	GLOBAL
Supporting employee health and well-being	76%	64%
Providing effective reskilling and upskilling	65%	63%
Improving talent progression and promotion processes	62%	62%
Tapping into diverse talent pools	51%	47%
Offering higher wages	50%	50%

Key barriers for business transformation

Transformation barriers

Share of organisations surveyed expecting the barriers will hinder their organisation transformation

Industry ▲ Global

	INDUSTRY	GLOBAL
Skills gaps in the labour market	65%	63%
Organization culture and resistance to change	40%	46%
Lack of adequate data and technical infrastructure	39%	32%
Inability to attract talent to the industry	38%	37%
Outdated or inflexible regulatory framework	32%	39%

Wage outlook

Wage trends

Share of organizations projecting the share of wages and other forms of workers' compensation as percentage of the company's total revenues

Growing | Global | Similar | Global | Declining | Global

58% 38% 4%

8% 52% 41%

Talent availability outlook

Talent trend

Share of respondents who expect their talent availability to improve or worsen in five years

Improving ▲ Global average | Worsening ▲ Global average

Talent availability when hiring

36% -100% +100% 28%

Talent development of existing workforce

14% -100% +100% 30%

Talent retention of existing workforce

67% -100% +100% 37%

DEI Actions

Share of employers surveyed planning to implement the diversity, equity and inclusion measure

51 | Global 51	45 | Global 48	38 | Global 42
Run comprehensive DEI training for managers and staff	Targeted recruitment, retention and progression initiatives	Set DEI goals, targets or quotas

AI Strategy

Share of employers surveyed planning to implement the stated strategy in response to AI's increasing capability and prevalence

70 | Global 77	68 | Global 69	63 | Global 62
Reskilling and upskilling your existing workforce to better work alongside AI	Hiring new people with skills to design AI tools and enhancements appropriate for the organization-specific skills	Hiring new people with skills to better work alongside AI